

# ZHONGJUN ZHANG

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## EDUCATION

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- Northwestern University**, Evanston, IL 09/2024 –  
Ph.D. candidate in Industrial Engineering and Management Sciences  
Advisor: [Sean R. Sinclair](#)
- University of Michigan**, Ann Arbor, MI 08/2022 – 04/2024  
MS in Industrial and Operations Engineering
- University of Science and Technology of China**, Hefei, China 08/2014 – 06/2018  
B.S. in Statistics

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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**Theory:** Online Learning, Data-Driven Optimization, Statistical Learning Theory, Game Theory  
**Application:** Supply Chain Management, Revenue Management, Resource Allocation

## PUBLICATIONS & WORKING PAPERS

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1. “[Reinforcement Learning in MDPs with Information-Ordered Policies](#)”, Zhongjun Zhang, Shipra Agrawal, Ilan Lobel, Sean R. Sinclair, and Christina Lee Yu.  
*Operations Research*, Major Revision  
**2025 INFORMS George Nicholson Finalist**
2. “[Offline–Online Reinforcement Learning for Linear Mixture MDPs](#)”, Zhongjun Zhang and Sean R. Sinclair.  
*NeurIPS 2026*

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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1. “Reinforcement Learning in MDPs with Information-Ordered Policies”, INFORMS 2025 (Atlanta, GA).
2. “Integrating Graph-based Structure and Time-Series in Demand Forecasting”, INFORMS 2019 (Seattle, WA).

## INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

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- Applied Scientist Intern**, Amazon 06/2026 – 09/2026  
Amazon Logistics  
– Reinforcement learning for labor planning in delivery stations.
- Research Scientist Intern**, Amazon 05/2023 – 08/2023  
Supply Chain Optimization Technology (SCOT) Group  
– Developed a freight-route-network-embedded model to predict inbound shipment lead-time distributions, improving long-lead import forecasts by 17% over the deployed baseline.
- Algorithm Engineer**, Alibaba 07/2018 – 07/2022  
Alibaba Cloud  
– Served as team technical lead (2020–2022)  
– Selected projects:  
– Supply chain demand prediction  
– Cloud computing resource allocation and scheduling

- Customer churning prediction and reacquisition strategy optimization
- Customer-oriented slow-moving items recommendation
- Customer-specific pricing for computing resources

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### Teaching Assistant

- Northwestern University
  - IEMS 340 Qualitative Methods in Engr Systems Fall 2025
- University of Michigan
  - IOE 515 Stochastic Process I Fall 2023
  - IOE 517 Game Theory with Operations Applications Winter 2023

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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**Alibaba Star of Tomorrow Award** 2019

Awarded to one person from each department annually

**Outstanding Graduate of University of Science and Technology of China** 2018

One of three students selected (top 3 of 111) from the Class of 2018, School of Management